lactic acid, pH decreases to a level of 6.3 – 6.5 to 4.6 – 4.7. The flavour in yoghurt is due to acetaldehyde which should be present at 23 – 41 mg/kg (Figure 5.7).



Figure 5.7: Yoghurt



Kefir: Kefir is in fact, fermented milk, produced by a mixed lactic acid bacteria and alcoholic yeast. The microflora responsible is not spread uniformly throughout the milk but is supplemented as discrete kefir grains. The Kefiran i.e. large layers of polysaccharide material folds upon to produce a cauliflower like Florets produce Kefir. The capsular homo fermentative *Lactobacillus kefiranolaciens* produces Kefiran. Lactobacillus Kefir contributes the required effervescence in the product.



5.8 Curd

Curd is a dairy product obtained by curdling or coagulating milk with rennet or an edible acidity substance such as lemon juice or vinegar and then draining off the liquid portion called whey milk that has been left to sour (raw) milk alone or pasteurized milk with added lactic acid bacteria or yeast (Example: *Lactobacillus acidophilus*) will also naturally produce curds and sour milk cheese is produced this way. The increased acidity causes the milk protein (casein) to tangle into solid masses or curds in cow's milk, 80% of the protein and caseins (Figure 5.8).



Figure 5.8: Curd

Uses

- Enhances healthy digestion
- improves immunity
- For stronger bones and teeth
- Helps to lose weight
- Beauty benefits of curd – for healthy and Radiant skin, prevent premature wrinkles remove dark spots and dandruff.

Summary

Micro organisms are associated, in a variety of ways with all of the food we eat. They may influence the quality, availability and quantity of our food naturally occurring

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